



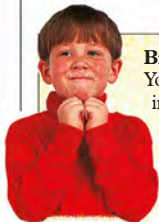
BRAIN



Inside your head, protected by a bony skull, is your brain. It looks crinkled like a walnut and is the control center for your entire body. Your heart pumps oxygen-filled blood into it through a mass of tubes, called arteries.

After only four minutes without oxygen, brain cells will die and they cannot be replaced. Your brain is very complex and is divided into many parts that have different functions. The largest and uppermost part in the human brain is called the cerebrum. It has two halves, called hemispheres. The outermost layer of the cerebrum also contains sections known as lobes, which control different activities and make sense of the information from your five senses.

The frontal lobe is the part of the brain where you do your big thinking. You use it when you make a decision or solve a problem. It also allows you to communicate with other people and express your own unique personality.



Brain control

Your brain is the most important part of your body. It is your control center, but is only a little bigger than your two fists!

Each part of your brain has a different job to do. Some parts send out signals to your body and some parts make sense of signals that come in.



Brain protection

To stop you from injuring your brain, you should wear a helmet whenever you take part in a sport that might make you hit your head.



The brain stem controls many of your automatic actions, such as your heartbeat and breathing.